PROJECT DESIGN PHASE | 2 MARKS

Problem–Solution Fit

Software Installation Request – ServiceNow

DATE	TEAM ID	PROJECT NAME	MAXIMUM MARKS
20 October 2026		**Software Installation Request – ServiceNow**	**2 Marks**

1. Solution Fit

The **Software Installation Request** solution is a ServiceNow Service Catalog and Flow Designer process for employees who need company-approved software installed for work. It replaces an informal, difficult-to-track request path with one structured catalog item that captures the software name, required version, business reason, and urgency. The Requested Item is routed to the requester's manager for approval. When approved, the flow creates a fulfillment Catalog Task for the Software Support Team and monitors the task until an outcome is recorded.

The solution addresses both normal fulfillment and a license-shortage exception. When the Catalog Task is **Closed Complete**, the flow follows the completion email path. In this project, **Pending** is used as the license-unavailable signal because the available Catalog Task state choices did not include On Hold; the shortage email explains that obtaining a new license is expected to take approximately one week. A separate Business Rule on Requested Item [sc_req_item] creates an Incident when the Requested Item is moved to On Hold for a license issue.

Customer Need and Solution Response

CUSTOMER NEED / PROBLEM	PROJECT RESPONSE
One clear request channel. Employees need a consistent way to ask for software installation.	An active Service Catalog item named **Software Installation Request**, categorized under Software.
Complete request details. Support staff need the software, version, business reason, and urgency.	Four catalog variables collect: software name; version (if required); reason for needing the software; and urgency level.
Controlled approval. Requests need a manager decision before fulfillment begins.	Flow Designer uses Ask For Approval on the Requested Item and routes approval to the requester's manager. The fulfillment branch proceeds when the approval state is Approved.
Clear fulfillment ownership. The employee needs the request to reach the responsible support team.	The flow creates a Catalog Task linked to the Requested Item, with short description "Software Fulfillment Task" and assignment group "Software Support Team."
Understandable outcome communication. The employee needs confirmation or an explanation of delay.	A Wait For Condition monitors the Catalog Task. Closed Complete follows the success email; Pending follows the license-unavailable email. Get Catalog Variables supplies the request details for personalization.

Fit conclusion

The proposed solution fits the identified employee and support-team needs because it connects request intake, manager approval, task ownership, task outcome monitoring, and requester communication in one ServiceNow process. It improves structure and traceability without claiming to automatically purchase licenses or install software: the Software Support Team performs the fulfillment work, while the workflow coordinates and records it.

Expected, not measured: less incomplete request information, clearer accountability, fewer avoidable status follow-ups, and better requester awareness of completion or license-related delay. These are intended benefits; no quantified time or cost reduction is claimed in this fit assessment.

2. Problem–Solution Fit Canvas

The canvas uses the nine areas in the supplied Problem–Solution Fit reference and applies them to the Software Installation Request project.

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

- **Primary:** employees who need company-approved software installed to perform daily work.
- **Secondary:** managers who review business need and approve requests.
- **Operational:** Software Support Team members who fulfil approved requests and report outcomes.

2. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS

- Employee must identify the correct software and version.
- A business reason and urgency must be supplied.
- Manager approval is required before fulfillment.
- Installation timing depends on support capacity and license availability.

3. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS / ALTERNATIVES

- Direct contact with IT/support by email or chat.
- Phone or in-person request and follow-up.
- Generic service-desk ticketing or informal tracking, where available.

These are comparison alternatives, not claims about a verified current process at the organization.

4. CUSTOMER PROBLEMS

- Request details may be incomplete or inconsistent.
- Employee may be unsure who approves or fulfils the request.
- Approval and fulfillment can take time.
- Status may be unclear, especially when a license is unavailable.

5. ROOT CAUSES

- No single structured intake path for required software details.
- Approval and fulfillment require coordination between different roles.
- Task ownership and outcome need explicit tracking.
- A license shortage is a real dependency that can prevent immediate installation.

6. CUSTOMER BEHAVIOUR

- Employee identifies the software and required version.
- Enters business reason and urgency in the catalog item.
- Submits the request and waits for manager approval.
- May check progress or ask for an update if fulfillment is delayed.

7. SOLUTION

- ServiceNow catalog item with four request variables.
- Flow Designer approval assigned to the requester's manager.
- Approved request creates a Catalog Task for Software Support Team.
- Task outcome drives a personalized completion or license-unavailable email.
- Separate Requested Item Business Rule creates an Incident for On Hold license issues.

8. CHANNELS

- ServiceNow Service Catalog: employee request submission.
- Flow Designer / Workflow Studio: approval, task creation, wait and branching logic.
- Catalog Task: support-team fulfillment record.
- Email: requester outcome communication.
- Incident: separate license-issue exception record.

9. EXPECTED BENEFITS

- More consistent and complete software requests.
- Approval decision and fulfillment ownership are traceable.
- Clear distinction between completed and license-delayed tasks.
- Requester receives a relevant status message and estimated one-week license delay.
- Incident record supports visibility of a license issue.

SOLUTION WORKFLOW

Employee submits catalog item → Manager approval → Approved? → Create Catalog Task for Software Support Team → Get Catalog Variables → Wait for task state → Closed Complete: completion email / Pending: license-unavailable email

3. ServiceNow Implementation Evidence

Screenshots from the project configuration are included as supporting evidence for the fit assessment.

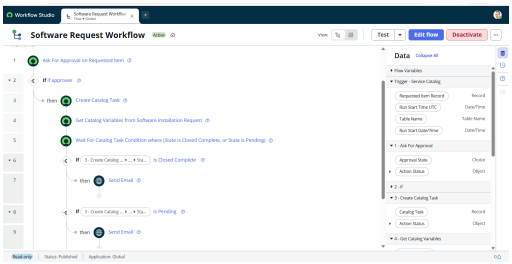


Figure 1. Published Software Request Workflow: approval, task creation, catalog-variable retrieval, wait condition, and separate outcome branches.

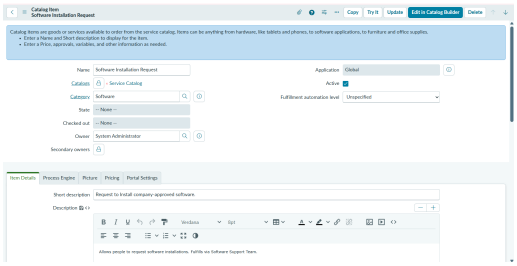


Figure 2. Active Software Installation Request catalog item, categorized under Software.

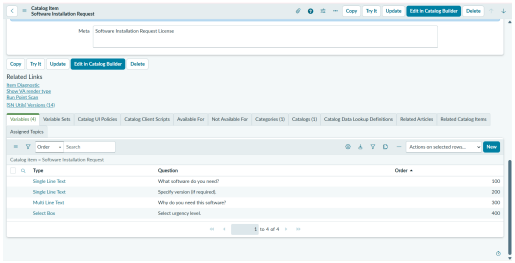


Figure 3. The catalog item contains four request variables for software, version, business reason, and urgency.

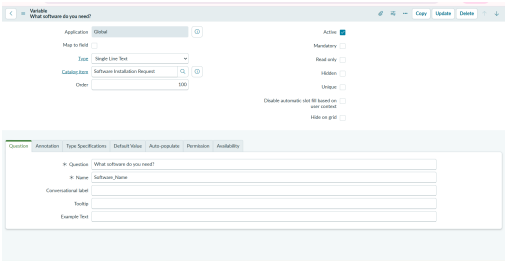


Figure 4. The software-name variable is a Single Line Text variable with internal name **Software_Name**.

Implementation details and project evidence

AREA	RECORDED PROJECT CONFIGURATION
Catalog item	Software Installation Request; category Software; active; short description “Request to Install company-approved software.”
Request variables	What software do you need? (Single Line Text, order 100); Specify version (if required). (Single Line Text, 200); Why do you need this software? (Multi Line Text, 300); Select urgency level. (Select Box, 400).
Approval and fulfillment	Ask For Approval uses the Requested Item record and the requester’s manager. Approved requests create a Catalog Task linked to the RITM, short description “Software Fulfillment Task,” assigned to Software Support Team.
Task outcome	Create Catalog Task has Wait turned off; a separate Wait For Condition monitors Catalog Task state = Closed Complete OR Pending. Pending is the project-specific license-unavailable signal because On Hold was not available in the Catalog Task state choices.
Email personalization	Get Catalog Variables exposes catalog answers for the email body. The intended messages address the requester by name and include the requested software; the shortage message explains an expected one-week wait for a new license.
License-issue Incident	Business Rule “Create Incident on License Issue”; table Requested Item [sc_req_item]; after insert/update; checks On Hold (state 3) and creates an Incident. The recorded script sets priority 3, caller to Requested for, and assignment group display value “Software Support.”
Test record example	Previously recorded request REQ0010003 / RITM0010003 used Microsoft Office 365, version 2021, reason “Required for Daily work,” urgency High. Fulfillment task SCTASK0010007 was created for Software Support Team with short description “Software Fulfillment Task.”
Configuration package	Update Set “Software Installation Request Setup” is In Progress in Global and includes the catalog item, category, four variables, three question choices, flow, and form layout. The project was also reported as successfully verified in a second instance (Instance B).

Implementation boundary: The project uses ServiceNow Flow Designer / Workflow Studio, not Legacy Workflow. The workflow coordinates approval, task assignment, waiting, and email notifications; it does not itself demonstrate automated software deployment or license procurement. Those actions remain part of the support team’s fulfillment process.

Reference basis: supplied “Problem – Solution Fit Template v1” and sample “3.1 Solution Fit.pdf.” Project details are drawn from the Software Installation Request brainstorming, problem-statement and empathy-map documents, configuration screenshots, and the project conversation.